

Lame Frames

Q I have an LG MyPC with a 2.4 GHz Intel 845 Processor, 256 MB RAM, and a 40 GB Disk running Windows XP SP2. I also have a Sony Hi 8 handycam. The software on the application CD captures my videos in AVI format, thus eating up loads of space, so I use Windows Movie Maker to capture, edit, and finalise movies from the cam.

When I save them they get saved in WMV format, requiring me to convert them to DAT to view the videos on a CD player. For this I use the videodisc option in Nero and add the WMV files to it.

Nero converts the files to DAT and writes them to CD, which I can view, but these DAT files come with a lower frame rate, and it seems like the movie is running in slow motion even when viewed on a computer. The WMV files

still work properly. What could be the problem? My friend tells me it's because of low RAM.

Anshul "A. J." Joshi

A The amount of RAM is not the cause of this problem—what you have is sufficient for converting WMV files to DAT. We suggest that you save your movies from WMM with a different FPS setting before sending it to Nero to convert to DAT. You can set this when saving the file in WMM; when you come to the page with the radio button "Best quality for playback on my computer", click on "Show more choices", and choose a format with a different FPS from the one you are currently using. You can see the FPS in the lower left corner of the dialog box. Be sure to stay away from the DVI format; this will save the movie in AVI format, but will end up as a very large file.

Second Things First

Q I recently downloaded *Prince of Persia 3D* patch v1.1. But ever since I installed it, *Prince of Persia 3D* gives an error message saying "Insert the 2nd CD-ROM into the drive" even when the second CD is sitting in the drive. What's up?

Nikhil Vemula

A If you have taken a backup of your original discs and are running the game using the backup discs, we suggest you use the original discs to start the game. If you still encounter the problem, go through this diagnostic checklist:

❑ If you have two or more CD drives, insert the *Prince of Persia* disc in the drive that has an earlier drive letter than the others.

❑ Again, if you are using two or more CD drives, disconnect all but one drive, insert the CD, and play.

❑ Uninstall any third-party CD-ROM emulation software like Daemon tools or Alcohol; they can sometimes cause problems with certain CD protection systems (SecuROM in this case).

If this doesn't help, you are left with no choice but to perform a reinstall of the game. And this time, don't apply the patch!

Welcome Woes

Q I use Windows XP Professional. The Welcome Screen has changed to that in older versions of Windows. How do I get rid of this and get the standard Windows XP Welcome Screen back?

N K R Vivek

A The Windows XP Welcome Screen is only available on computers that aren't members of a domain. If your computer is a standalone, then, under User Accounts in the Control Panel, click on "Change the way users log on or off". Select "Use the Welcome Screen". You should now see the Windows XP Welcome Screen at startup.

No COMfort

Q I have an HP Pavilion 6506 with an AMD K6 processor running 450 MHz, a 20 GB HDD, 256 MB of SDRAM, and Win98 SE multi-booting

with Windows XP Professional, to which I upgraded recently. I noticed that there is no COM port in the Device Manager. Checking in Add/Remove Hardware also did not show up anything, and there is no Communication Wizard. Because of this, I can't use my dial-up modem. I want to know why the COM port vanished after I installed XP. All other drivers—for display, sound, etc.—work fine.

Rajesh Sharma

A First update your motherboard and modem drivers to the latest versions available. Also, install Windows XP Service Pack 2. If this doesn't fix the problem, then in the BIOS, disable all your COM ports, boot into XP, restart, re-enable the ports, and again boot into XP. This should take care of the problem.

Out Of Control

Q After installing Windows Vista customizing pack v3 from the *Digit* CD, my system lost the Volume icon in the notification area. When I try to fix this problem using the Sounds and Audio Devices Properties and try to check "Place volume icon in the taskbar", I get the following error:

"Windows cannot display the volume control on the taskbar because the volume control program has not been installed. To install it use Add/Remove programs in the Control Panel".

Under the Audio tab, when I press the Volume button, I get this error:

"Windows cannot execute SndVol32.exe. Use Add/Remove programs in the Control Panel to install it".

Vismay Badiani

A You just need to extract the sndvol32.exe file from the Windows XP CD. At a command prompt, enter these commands without the quotes, where X is your CD drive letter:

"X:"

"CD i386"

"expand -r sndvol32.ex_

C:\windows\system32"

(The path "C:\windows" means the path to where you installed XP; change this if you installed Windows elsewhere)

You should now be able to enable the volume control. ■



Get Help Now!

E-mail us your computing problems along with your contact details and complete system configuration to sos@jasubhai.com, and we might answer them here! Since we get many more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!